

Keyboard Shortcuts

Lesson 21 — High-Yield Keys and Combinations

JKSSB Computer Awareness

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Reading a Keyboard Shortcut

- ▶ A **keyboard shortcut** is a key or a combination of keys that performs a command directly, without opening a menu.
- ▶ In a combination such as **Ctrl+C**, the plus sign means: hold the first key down, then tap the second.
- ▶ The modifier keys are **Ctrl** (Control), **Alt** (Alternate), **Shift**, and the **Windows (Win)** key.
- ▶ **Function keys** F1–F12 form the top row of the keyboard.

The one idea

A shortcut is the same command as the menu item — just reached with the keyboard instead of the mouse.

The Clipboard Trio: Copy, Cut, Paste

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+C	Copy the selected item
Ctrl+X	Cut the selected item
Ctrl+V	Paste the copied or cut item

Trap alert

Copy leaves the original in place; **Cut** removes the original. Do not treat Ctrl+C and Ctrl+X as the same command.

Undo, Redo, Select All

- ▶ **Ctrl+Z** — Undo the last action.
- ▶ **Ctrl+Y** — Redo the action that was undone.
- ▶ **Ctrl+A** — Select All the content in the current window or document.

Undo and redo are a pair

Ctrl+Z steps backward; Ctrl+Y steps forward again. They are not interchangeable.

Save, Print, Find, Replace

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+S	Save the current file
Ctrl+P	Print
Ctrl+F	Find (search) text
Ctrl+H	Replace text

Find locates a word; Replace finds it and substitutes another.

Trap Alert: The Ctrl Near-Neighbours

- | | | |
|------------------------|-----|--------------------------|
| ▶ Ctrl+Z = Undo | not | Ctrl+Y = Redo. |
| ▶ Ctrl+F = Find | not | Ctrl+H = Replace. |
| ▶ Ctrl+C = Copy | not | Ctrl+X = Cut. |
| ▶ Ctrl+S = Save | not | Ctrl+P = Print. |

Read the letter, not the habit

The whole mark of these items is the **second key**. Slow down and read the exact letter.

Alt-Key Combinations

- ▶ **Alt+Tab** — Switch between the open windows or running applications.
- ▶ **Alt+F4** — Close the active window or application.
- ▶ On the desktop with no window open, Alt+F4 opens the shutdown / sign-out dialog.

Alt means an alternative action

Alt combinations mostly manage *windows*, while Ctrl combinations manage *content*.

Trap Alert: Alt+Tab vs Alt+F4

Shortcut	What it does
Alt+Tab	Moves to another open window (does <i>not</i> close one)
Alt+F4	Closes the active window (does <i>not</i> just switch)

Trap alert

Alt+Tab **switches**; Alt+F4 **closes**. Reversing the two is a common wrong answer.

The Function Keys

- ▶ Function keys are **single keys** on the top row: F1 to F12.
- ▶ Their action depends on the application that is active.
- ▶ The high-yield set for the exam is **F1**, **F2**, **F5**, and **F7**.
- ▶ Pressing a function key alone is not a combination; no modifier is held.

One key, one job

Learn each high-yield function key with its standard job before learning application-specific behaviour.

Function-Key Quick Table

Key	Standard action
F1	Help
F2	Rename the selected file or folder
F5	Refresh the window / start a slide show from the beginning
F7	Spelling and grammar check (MS Word)

F1 help, F2 rename, F5 refresh/slide show, F7 spell check.

F5 and Shift+F5 in PowerPoint

- ▶ **F5** — Start the slide show **from the beginning**.
- ▶ **Shift+F5** — Start the slide show **from the current slide**.
- ▶ In Windows (not in a slide show), **F5** means **Refresh** the folder or window.

Documented exam fact

Website Operator 2026 asked the key that starts a slide show from the beginning — the answer is **F5** (PYQ WO 2026 Q80).

The Windows-Key Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Win+D	Show the desktop (minimise all windows)
Win+E	Open File Explorer
Win+L	Lock the computer

D for Desktop, E for Explorer, L for Lock.

The Shift Key

- ▶ **Shift** produces the capital letter or the symbol on the upper part of a key.
- ▶ **Shift+Click** selects a **range** of items between two clicks.
- ▶ **Shift+F5** starts a slide show from the current slide.
- ▶ Held with a letter, Shift does not save, close, or print anything; it changes *what is typed or selected*.

Key to Action: Recall Table

Key	Action	Key	Action
Ctrl+C	Copy	Ctrl+S	Save
Ctrl+X	Cut	Ctrl+P	Print
Ctrl+V	Paste	Ctrl+F	Find
Ctrl+Z	Undo	Ctrl+H	Replace
Ctrl+Y	Redo	F1	Help
Ctrl+A	Select All	F2	Rename
Alt+Tab	Switch window	F5	Refresh / slide show
Alt+F4	Close window	F7	Spell check

Trap Alert: Most-Missed Near-Neighbours

▶ F1 Help	not	F2 Rename.
▶ F5 Refresh or slide show	not	F7 Spell check.
▶ Ctrl+Z Undo	not	Ctrl+Y Redo.
▶ Ctrl+F Find	not	Ctrl+H Replace.
▶ Alt+Tab Switch	not	Alt+F4 Close.

Lesson 21: Recall

- ▶ Clipboard: **Ctrl+C** copy, **Ctrl+X** cut, **Ctrl+V** paste.
- ▶ Edit: **Ctrl+Z** undo, **Ctrl+Y** redo, **Ctrl+A** select all.
- ▶ File and search: **Ctrl+S** save, **Ctrl+P** print, **Ctrl+F** find, **Ctrl+H** replace.
- ▶ Windows: **Alt+Tab** switch, **Alt+F4** close, **Win+D** show desktop, **Win+E** File Explorer, **Win+L** lock.
- ▶ Function keys: **F1** help, **F2** rename, **F5** refresh/slide show, **F7** spell check.
- ▶ **Shift+F5** starts a slide show from the current slide.